Physical Risk Factor Ergonomic Checklist Instructions

The Physical Risk Factor Ergonomic Checklist is a tool used in work places to identify and evaluate ergonomic stressors. The checklist can be used for typical work activities, which are a regular and foreseeable part of the job, occurring more than one day per week, and more frequently than one week per year.

For each category determine whether the physical risk factors rate as a "**caution**" or "**hazard**" by placing a check (**X**) in the appropriate box. Note if a category is not applicable.

If a work place "**hazard**" exists, it must be reduced below the hazard level or to the degree technologically and economically feasible. Ensure workers exposed to ergonomic stressors at or above the "**hazard**" level receive general ergonomics training.

If the task rates a "**caution**," then it should be periodically reassessed since changes in the work environment may create new ergonomic stressors. A work activity that is found to be a "**caution or hazard**" can be evaluated further using the Job Requirements and Physical Demands Survey, resources for which are found in appendix C.

Ensure significant contributing physical or personal risk factors are not present. Contributing factors contribute to but do not cause Work-Related Musculoskeletal Disorders. Physical contributing factors may include temperature extreme, inadequate recovery time, and stress on the job.

Non-occupational factors (personal contributing factors) may include but are not limited to age, pregnancy, obesity, wrist / knee / ankle strain or fracture, back strain, thyroid disorder, rheumatoid arthritis, hypertension, diabetes, kidney disorders, gout; as well as tendonitis / tenosynovitis, epicondylitis, thoracic outlet syndrome, ganglion cyst, bursitis, trigger finger, and carpal tunnel syndrome. Professional judgment should be used in instances where personal or physical contributing factors are present.

Also, note that the risk of developing a Work-Related Musculoskeletal Disorder increases when ergonomic risk factors occur in combination.